

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

NovaCRM User Guide

Product: NovaCRM Enterprise Customer Relationship Management Platform

Document ID: PROD-CRM-001

Version: 4.1

Release Date: January 2026

Prepared By: Product Engineering Division

Classification: Internal Use Only

Document Control

Field	Value
Product	NovaCRM
Version	4.1
Status	Approved
Product Owner	CRM Engineering Team
Last Updated	January 2026
Review Cycle	Every 6 Months

Table of Contents

1. Introduction
 2. Product Overview
 3. Core Features
 4. System Requirements
 5. Supported Browsers
 6. Logging In
 7. Dashboard Overview
 8. Customer Management
 9. Revision History
-

1. Introduction

Welcome to NovaCRM, NovaTech Solutions' enterprise Customer Relationship Management platform.

NovaCRM enables organizations to manage customers, sales opportunities, contacts, accounts, communications, and business relationships from a centralized cloud platform.

The application is designed for:

- Sales Teams
- Business Development
- Customer Success
- Marketing
- Sales Managers
- Executives

NovaCRM provides complete visibility into the customer lifecycle—from lead generation through sales closure and post-sales support.

This guide introduces the standard features available to business users.

Administrative configuration is documented separately in the **NovaCRM Administrator Guide (PROD-CRM-ADM-002)**.

2. Product Overview

NovaCRM helps organizations build long-term customer relationships while improving sales productivity.

The platform centralizes customer information and enables collaboration between sales, marketing, customer success, and leadership teams.

Major capabilities include:

- Lead Management
- Contact Management
- Account Management
- Opportunity Tracking
- Sales Pipeline
- Activity Management
- Email Integration
- Calendar Integration

- Reports
- Sales Forecasting
- Workflow Automation
- Customer Analytics

NovaCRM is available as a cloud-hosted Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) application and supports organizations with thousands of users across multiple geographic regions.

Business Benefits

NovaCRM helps organizations:

- Improve lead conversion.
 - Increase sales visibility.
 - Reduce manual data entry.
 - Automate repetitive tasks.
 - Improve customer engagement.
 - Forecast revenue accurately.
 - Maintain a centralized customer database.
-

3. Core Features

Lead Management

Capture leads from:

- Website forms
- Marketing campaigns
- Email inquiries
- Phone calls
- Trade shows
- Manual entry
- API integrations

Leads can be assigned automatically based on predefined routing rules.

Contact Management

Every customer contact record stores:

- Full Name
- Job Title
- Email Address
- Phone Number
- Department
- Company
- Address
- Communication History
- Notes

All customer interactions remain associated with the contact profile.

Account Management

Accounts represent organizations doing business with NovaTech.

Each account contains:

- Company Name
 - Industry
 - Company Size
 - Billing Address
 - Shipping Address
 - Annual Revenue
 - Assigned Account Manager
 - Open Opportunities
 - Active Contracts
-

Opportunity Management

Sales opportunities help track potential revenue.

Each opportunity contains:

- Opportunity Name
- Expected Revenue
- Stage

- Probability
- Expected Close Date
- Assigned Sales Representative
- Competitors
- Products
- Notes

Managers can monitor every sales opportunity from qualification through closure.

Activity Management

NovaCRM tracks all customer interactions including:

- Calls
- Emails
- Meetings
- Follow-ups
- Demonstrations
- Tasks

Activities automatically appear within the customer timeline.

Workflow Automation

Automation reduces repetitive administrative work.

Examples include:

- Automatic Lead Assignment
 - Opportunity Stage Notifications
 - Follow-up Reminders
 - Approval Workflows
 - Customer Welcome Emails
-

Reports

NovaCRM includes real-time dashboards for monitoring sales performance.

Available reports include:

- Sales Pipeline
- Revenue Forecast
- Lead Conversion
- Sales Activities
- Customer Growth
- Opportunity Aging
- Closed Deals

4. System Requirements

NovaCRM supports modern desktop operating systems.

Supported Operating Systems

Operating System	Minimum Version
Windows	Windows 10
macOS	macOS 12
Ubuntu	Ubuntu 22.04 LTS
Red Hat Enterprise Linux	Version 9

Hardware Requirements

Component	Minimum	Recommended
CPU	Dual Core	Quad Core
RAM	8 GB	16 GB
Storage	5 GB Free	20 GB Free
Display	1366×768	Full HD

Internet Requirements

Activity	Minimum Speed
General Usage	10 Mbps
Video Meetings	25 Mbps

Dashboard Analytics 50 Mbps

A reliable broadband connection is recommended for uninterrupted access.

5. Supported Browsers

NovaCRM officially supports:

- Google Chrome
- Microsoft Edge
- Mozilla Firefox
- Apple Safari

Always use the latest stable browser version.

Internet Explorer is not supported.

JavaScript and cookies must remain enabled for full application functionality.

6. Logging In

Employees receive NovaCRM credentials during onboarding.

Login Procedure

1. Open the NovaCRM URL provided by your organization.
2. Enter your corporate email address.
3. Enter your password.
4. Complete Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
5. Select **Sign In**.

After successful authentication, the user is redirected to the Home Dashboard.

Password Requirements

Passwords must include:

- Minimum 12 characters
- One uppercase letter
- One lowercase letter
- One numeric digit
- One special character

Passwords expire every **90 days**.

The previous **five passwords** cannot be reused.

Multi-Factor Authentication

NovaCRM supports:

- Authenticator Applications
- SMS Verification
- Email Verification
- Hardware Security Keys

MFA is mandatory for users with administrative privileges and recommended for all employees.

Account Lockout

Accounts are temporarily locked after **five consecutive unsuccessful login attempts**.

Locked accounts automatically unlock after **30 minutes**, or they may be unlocked earlier by the IT Helpdesk after identity verification.

7. Dashboard Overview

The Home Dashboard provides an overview of sales performance and daily activities.

Displayed information depends on the user's role.

Dashboard Components

Navigation Menu

Provides access to:

- Dashboard
- Leads
- Contacts
- Accounts
- Opportunities
- Activities
- Reports

- Calendar
 - Settings
 - Administration (authorized users only)
-

Sales Summary

Displays:

- Open Opportunities
- Opportunities Won
- Opportunities Lost
- Monthly Revenue
- Quarterly Revenue
- Pipeline Value

These metrics update in real time.

My Tasks

Displays upcoming:

- Calls
- Meetings
- Follow-ups
- Demonstrations
- Approval Requests

Tasks can be sorted by due date, priority, or customer.

Sales Pipeline Widget

Displays the current pipeline grouped by sales stage.

Typical stages include:

- New Lead
- Qualified
- Proposal Sent
- Negotiation

- Closed Won
- Closed Lost

Users can drill down into each stage to view individual opportunities.

Calendar Widget

The dashboard integrates with Microsoft Outlook and Google Calendar.

Scheduled meetings and reminders appear automatically.

Users may:

- Create meetings
 - Accept invitations
 - View upcoming events
 - Schedule follow-up activities
-

Notifications

Users receive notifications for:

- New Lead Assignment
- Opportunity Updates
- Meeting Reminders
- Approval Requests
- Workflow Events
- Customer Responses

Unread notifications remain highlighted until acknowledged.

Search

The global search feature allows users to search for:

- Customers
- Contacts
- Opportunities
- Leads
- Companies

- Activities
- Notes

Search results are ranked by relevance and recent activity.

8. Customer Management

Customer Management forms the foundation of NovaCRM.

Every customer record maintains a complete history of interactions throughout the business relationship.

Each customer profile includes:

- Company Information
- Contacts
- Active Opportunities
- Sales Activities
- Support History
- Documents
- Contracts
- Notes
- Communication Timeline

This centralized view enables every department to access consistent customer information while maintaining appropriate role-based permissions.

Customer Timeline

Every interaction is automatically recorded.

Timeline entries include:

- Phone Calls
- Emails
- Meetings
- Product Demonstrations
- Quotes
- Contracts
- Opportunity Updates

- Support Tickets

The timeline provides a chronological view of the customer relationship, helping teams understand past interactions before engaging with the customer again.

Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	January 2024	Initial CRM Release
2.0	January 2025	Added Opportunity Management
3.0	August 2025	Added Workflow Automation
4.0	October 2025	Introduced Sales Forecasting
4.1	January 2026	Updated Dashboard and Customer Management

9. Lead Management

Lead Management enables sales teams to capture, organize, qualify, and convert prospective customers into business opportunities.

A lead represents an individual or organization that has expressed interest in NovaTech products or services but has not yet become a qualified sales opportunity.

Every lead is assigned a unique Lead ID.

Example:

LD-2026-004582

Lead Sources

NovaCRM supports leads originating from multiple channels.

Common lead sources include:

- Corporate Website
- Marketing Campaigns
- Product Demonstrations
- Trade Shows
- Customer Referrals
- Partner Organizations
- Social Media Campaigns

- Email Marketing
- Manual Entry
- REST API Integrations

Capturing the lead source helps marketing teams evaluate campaign performance and return on investment.

Creating a Lead

To create a new lead:

1. Navigate to **Leads**.
2. Select **New Lead**.
3. Enter the required customer information.
4. Select the lead source.
5. Assign the lead owner.
6. Choose the industry.
7. Save the record.

Required fields include:

- First Name
- Last Name
- Company Name
- Business Email
- Country
- Lead Source

Additional information may be added later as more customer details become available.

Lead Status

Leads progress through predefined lifecycle stages.

Status	Description
New	Recently created lead
Contacted	Initial communication completed
Qualified	Meets qualification criteria

Status	Description
--------	-------------

Proposal Sent	Commercial proposal submitted
---------------	-------------------------------

Negotiation	Commercial discussions underway
-------------	---------------------------------

Converted	Converted into customer records
-----------	---------------------------------

Disqualified	Lead closed without conversion
--------------	--------------------------------

Managers may configure additional stages to align with business processes.

Lead Assignment

NovaCRM supports both manual and automated lead assignment.

Automatic routing may consider:

- Geographic region
- Industry
- Product interest
- Sales territory
- Account ownership
- Current workload

Assignment rules help distribute leads fairly across sales teams.

10. Contact Management

Contacts represent individual people associated with customer organizations.

Each contact is linked to a customer account and may participate in multiple sales opportunities.

Contact Information

Each contact record includes:

- Full Name
- Job Title
- Email Address
- Mobile Number
- Office Number

- Department
- Preferred Language
- Preferred Communication Method
- Linked Account
- Assigned Account Manager

Communication history is automatically associated with the contact profile.

Contact Activities

Every interaction with a contact is recorded.

Supported activity types include:

- Phone Calls
- Emails
- Meetings
- Product Demonstrations
- Follow-up Tasks
- Notes
- File Attachments

This historical record helps sales representatives maintain continuity during customer interactions.

11. Account Management

An account represents a customer organization doing business with NovaTech.

Accounts serve as the parent record for contacts, opportunities, contracts, and activities.

Account Information

Each account contains:

- Company Name
- Industry
- Headquarters Location
- Number of Employees
- Annual Revenue

- Customer Tier
 - Assigned Account Manager
 - Account Status
 - Customer Since
 - Billing Address
 - Shipping Address
-

Customer Tiers

Customers may be categorized into service tiers.

Tier	Description
Platinum	Strategic enterprise customers
Gold	Large commercial customers
Silver	Mid-sized organizations
Standard	Small business customers

Customer tier influences support entitlements and account review frequency.

Account Status

Accounts may have one of the following statuses:

- Active
- Prospect
- Onboarding
- Suspended
- Inactive
- Closed

Status changes are recorded in the account audit history.

12. Opportunity Management

An opportunity represents a potential sales transaction.

Each opportunity is associated with a customer account and contributes to the sales pipeline.

Every opportunity receives a unique Opportunity ID.

Example:

OPP-2026-000391

Opportunity Information

Each opportunity includes:

- Opportunity Name
- Account
- Primary Contact
- Assigned Sales Representative
- Opportunity Value
- Expected Close Date
- Sales Stage
- Probability of Closure
- Products
- Competitors
- Notes

Sales Stages

NovaCRM supports the following default opportunity stages.

Stage	Probability
Prospecting	10%
Qualification	25%
Needs Analysis	40%
Proposal Submitted	60%
Negotiation	80%
Closed Won	100%
Closed Lost	0%

Probability values may be customized by administrators.

Opportunity Closure

When closing an opportunity, sales representatives must specify:

- Outcome
- Revenue
- Closing Date
- Competitor (if lost)
- Loss Reason
- Customer Feedback

Closed opportunities become read-only after approval by the sales manager.

13. Sales Pipeline

The Sales Pipeline provides a visual overview of all active opportunities.

The pipeline is displayed using a Kanban-style interface.

Opportunities may be moved between stages using drag-and-drop functionality.

Pipeline Metrics

Managers can monitor:

- Pipeline Value
- Expected Revenue
- Win Rate
- Average Deal Size
- Average Sales Cycle
- Opportunities by Stage
- Revenue by Sales Representative

Pipeline metrics are refreshed automatically every **15 minutes**.

Revenue Forecast

NovaCRM estimates future revenue based on:

- Opportunity Stage
- Probability of Closure

- Expected Close Date
- Historical Win Rates

Forecast reports assist leadership teams in planning quarterly and annual business targets.

14. Activities and Tasks

Sales activities help representatives organize customer engagement.

Activity types include:

- Phone Calls
- Meetings
- Emails
- Product Demonstrations
- Follow-up Tasks
- Site Visits

Activities may be linked to:

- Leads
 - Contacts
 - Accounts
 - Opportunities
-

Task Management

Each task contains:

- Subject
- Priority
- Due Date
- Assigned User
- Related Customer
- Related Opportunity
- Status

Tasks may be marked as:

- Not Started

- In Progress
- Waiting
- Completed
- Cancelled

Automatic reminders are sent **24 hours** before task deadlines.

Meeting Scheduling

NovaCRM integrates with supported calendar applications.

Meeting invitations include:

- Date
- Time
- Location
- Video Conference Link
- Participants
- Agenda
- Notes

Meeting outcomes may be recorded after completion.

15. Email Integration

NovaCRM supports secure integration with enterprise email systems.

Supported providers include:

- Microsoft 365
- Google Workspace
- Exchange Server

Users may:

- Send emails from CRM
- Track email opens
- Store conversations
- Attach emails to customer records
- Schedule follow-up reminders

All tracked emails become part of the customer communication history.

16. Sales Forecasting

Sales Forecasting helps managers estimate future revenue.

Forecasts are calculated using:

- Pipeline Value
- Opportunity Probability
- Historical Sales Data
- Seasonal Trends
- Territory Performance

Forecast reports may be generated:

- Weekly
- Monthly
- Quarterly
- Annually

Only managers and executives may approve official sales forecasts.

17. Best Practices

NovaTech recommends the following practices for all CRM users:

- Update opportunity stages promptly.
- Record customer meetings immediately after completion.
- Keep customer contact information current.
- Schedule follow-up tasks before closing meetings.
- Use standardized naming conventions for opportunities.
- Avoid duplicate customer records.
- Review pipeline health weekly.
- Maintain complete activity histories.

Consistent data quality improves reporting accuracy and forecasting reliability.

18. Reports and Analytics

NovaCRM provides comprehensive reporting capabilities that help sales representatives, managers, executives, and business analysts monitor organizational performance.

Reports are generated using real-time CRM data and can be customized according to business requirements.

Standard Reports

NovaCRM includes the following built-in reports.

Report	Description
Lead Summary	Overview of lead generation and qualification
Lead Conversion	Lead-to-customer conversion metrics
Sales Pipeline	Opportunity distribution across sales stages
Revenue Forecast	Predicted revenue by period
Opportunity Aging	Opportunities nearing expected close dates
Sales Activities	Calls, meetings, emails, and tasks completed
Customer Growth	New customer acquisition trends
Win/Loss Analysis	Reasons for successful and unsuccessful deals
Sales by Territory	Revenue grouped by geographic region
Executive Dashboard	High-level business KPIs

Report Filters

Reports may be filtered by:

- Date Range
- Sales Representative
- Region
- Product
- Industry
- Customer Tier
- Opportunity Stage
- Revenue Range

Users can save custom filter combinations for future use.

Report Export

Reports can be exported in:

- PDF
- CSV
- Microsoft Excel (.xlsx)

Scheduled reports may be automatically emailed to authorized recipients on a daily, weekly, or monthly basis.

19. Workflow Automation

NovaCRM includes a configurable workflow engine that automates routine business processes.

Automation reduces manual effort, improves consistency, and accelerates customer engagement.

Workflow Components

Each workflow consists of:

- Trigger
- Conditions
- Actions
- Notifications
- Approval Rules

Common Triggers

Administrators can configure workflows using events such as:

- Lead Created
- Lead Assigned
- Opportunity Created
- Opportunity Stage Updated
- Task Completed
- Customer Created

- Contract Expiring
 - Revenue Threshold Reached
-

Workflow Actions

Supported actions include:

- Assign Owner
- Send Email
- Schedule Task
- Create Meeting
- Notify Manager
- Update Opportunity Stage
- Generate Follow-up Reminder
- Create Approval Request

Multiple actions may execute as part of a single workflow.

Approval Workflows

NovaCRM supports configurable approval processes for:

- Discount Requests
- Contract Approval
- Sales Quotations
- Enterprise Deals
- Special Pricing
- Customer Credits

Approvers receive automated notifications and may approve or reject requests directly within NovaCRM.

20. Notifications

NovaCRM provides real-time notifications to help users stay informed.

Notifications are generated for:

- New Lead Assignment
- Opportunity Updates

- Customer Responses
 - Meeting Reminders
 - Task Deadlines
 - Approval Requests
 - Workflow Events
 - Contract Renewal Reminders
-

Notification Channels

Users may receive notifications through:

- In-Application Notifications
- Corporate Email
- Microsoft Teams
- Mobile Push Notifications (if enabled)

Critical system and security notifications remain enabled for all users.

Reminder Schedule

NovaCRM automatically generates reminders for:

Event	Reminder
Task Due Date	24 hours before
Scheduled Meeting	30 minutes before
Contract Renewal	30 days before
Opportunity Close Date	7 days before
Password Expiry	14 days before

21. User Preferences

Every user may personalize their NovaCRM experience.

Personal Settings

Users may update:

- Display Name

- Profile Photo
- Phone Number
- Time Zone
- Language
- Date Format
- Notification Preferences

Changes to official employee information must be made through the Human Resources system.

Theme Selection

NovaCRM supports:

- Light Theme
- Dark Theme
- System Default

User preferences are synchronized across supported devices after successful login.

Password Management

Password policy requirements include:

- Minimum 12 characters
- At least one uppercase letter
- At least one lowercase letter
- At least one number
- At least one special character

Passwords expire every **90 days**.

The previous **five passwords** cannot be reused.

Session Management

Users may:

- Review active login sessions
- Terminate sessions on other devices
- View login history

- Sign out from all devices

Sessions automatically expire after **30 minutes of inactivity**.

22. Role-Based Access Control

NovaCRM protects sensitive customer information using Role-Based Access Control (RBAC).

Each user is assigned one or more roles.

Standard Roles

Role	Responsibilities
Sales Representative	Manage assigned customers and opportunities
Sales Manager	Manage teams and approve deals
Marketing Executive	Manage campaigns and lead generation
Customer Success Manager	Handle customer relationships after sales
CRM Administrator	Configure the application and manage users
Executive	Access business dashboards and reports

Permissions are granted according to the principle of least privilege.

Data Security

Customer information is protected through:

- Multi-Factor Authentication
- Role-Based Access Control
- Audit Logging
- Encryption at Rest
- Encryption in Transit
- Session Management

Sensitive customer information should only be accessed for legitimate business purposes.

23. Security Best Practices

Employees using NovaCRM should:

- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication.
- Lock workstations before leaving.
- Verify customer identities before discussing confidential information.
- Log out from shared computers.
- Use company-approved devices.
- Report suspicious emails immediately.
- Install software updates promptly.

Employees must never:

- Share passwords.
- Export customer information without authorization.
- Store customer data on personal cloud storage.
- Install unauthorized software.
- Share screenshots containing confidential customer information.

Security incidents must be reported immediately to the Information Security Team.

24. Troubleshooting

The following table describes common issues and recommended resolutions.

Issue	Possible Cause	Recommended Resolution
Unable to sign in	Incorrect credentials	Verify username or reset password
Missing customer records	Access permissions	Contact CRM Administrator
Report generation slow	Large dataset	Apply report filters
Email synchronization failed	Mail server unavailable	Retry synchronization after a few minutes
Duplicate customer records	Manual duplicate entry	Merge duplicate records using administrator tools
Dashboard widgets not loading	Browser cache	Clear browser cache and reload

If the issue persists, contact the IT Service Desk.

Browser Recommendations

For optimal performance:

- Use the latest stable browser version.
 - Enable JavaScript.
 - Enable cookies.
 - Disable unsupported browser extensions if they interfere with application functionality.
-

Network Connectivity

If NovaCRM cannot connect to company services:

1. Verify internet connectivity.
 2. Refresh the browser.
 3. Connect through the corporate VPN if required.
 4. Retry the operation.
 5. Contact the Network Operations Team if the issue continues.
-

25. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. How do I create a new lead?

Navigate to **Leads**, select **New Lead**, complete the required fields, and click **Save**.

Q2. Can multiple contacts belong to one customer account?

Yes. An account may contain multiple contacts representing different individuals within the same organization.

Q3. How often are dashboard reports updated?

Dashboard reports and widgets refresh automatically every **15 minutes**.

Q4. Can I customize my dashboard?

Yes. Users can rearrange widgets, save report filters, and configure default dashboard layouts.

Q5. Which file formats are supported when exporting reports?

Reports may be exported as PDF, CSV, or Microsoft Excel (.xlsx).

Q6. How long before a contract renewal does NovaCRM generate reminders?

Contract renewal reminders are generated **30 days** before the contract expiration date.

Q7. Can I terminate active sessions on other devices?

Yes. Session management allows users to review and terminate active sessions on other devices.

Q8. What should I do if I discover duplicate customer records?

Notify your CRM Administrator or use the approved record merge functionality if you have the required permissions.

Q9. Who can approve enterprise discount requests?

Sales Managers or other designated approvers configured in the approval workflow can approve discount requests.

Q10. Who should I contact if I cannot resolve a technical issue?

Contact the IT Service Desk or the CRM Administrator, providing screenshots, error messages, and a description of the issue.

Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	January 2024	Initial CRM Release
2.0	January 2025	Added Opportunity Management
3.0	August 2025	Introduced Workflow Automation
4.0	October 2025	Added Sales Forecasting
4.1	January 2026	Updated Reporting, RBAC, and Security Guidance

Related Documentation

For additional information, refer to:

- NovaCRM Administrator Guide (PROD-CRM-ADM-002)

- NovaDesk User Guide (PROD-ND-001)
- Information Security Policy (COMP-SEC-003)
- Employee Handbook (HR-EMP-001)
- Customer Support Process Guide (PROC-CS-004)